# MAKI Cheat Sheet

Media Asset Keeper & Indexer — v4.3.4

## Global Options

| | |
|---|---|
| `--json` | JSON output to stdout |
| `-v, --verbose` | Show operational details |
| `-l, --log` | Per-file progress to stderr |
| `-d, --debug` | External tool debug output |
| `-t, --time` | Show elapsed time |

## Setup

**maki init**
Create a new catalog in the current directory.

**maki volume add** *[LABEL] PATH*
Register a storage volume (label auto-derived from path if omitted).
`--purpose media|working|archive|backup|cloud`

**maki volume list**
Show registered volumes with online/offline status.
`--purpose PURPOSE --offline --online`

**maki volume set-purpose** *LABEL PURPOSE*
Change a volume's logical role.

**maki volume remove** *LABEL*
Unregister a volume. `--apply`

**maki volume combine** *SOURCE TARGET*
Merge two volumes. `--apply`

**maki volume split** *SOURCE LABEL* **--path** *DIR*
Split subdirectory into new volume. `--apply --purpose`

**maki volume rename** *VOLUME LABEL*
Rename a volume.

## Ingest & Edit

**maki import** *PATHS...*
Import files into the catalog.
`--volume --profile NAME --auto-group --smart`
`--embed` [Pro] `--describe` [Pro] `--dry-run`
`--include GROUP --skip GROUP`

**maki delete** *ASSET_IDS...*
Delete assets. `--apply --remove-files`

**maki tag** *ASSET_ID TAGS...*
Add or remove tags. `--remove`

**maki tag rename** *OLD NEW*
Rename a tag across all assets. `--apply`

**maki tag clear** *ASSET_ID*
Remove all tags from an asset.

**maki edit** *ASSET_ID*
Edit metadata fields.
`--name --description --rating N`
`--label COLOR --date --clear-FIELD`

**maki group** *HASHES...*
Group variants into one asset.

**maki split** *ASSET_ID* **--variant** *HASH*
Split variants out of an asset.

**maki auto-group** *[QUERY]*
Auto-group by filename stem. `--apply`

**maki describe** *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Generate VLM image descriptions.
`--asset ID --volume --model`
`--mode describe|tags|both`
`--apply --force --dry-run`

**maki auto-tag** *[QUERY]* [Pro]
AI auto-tagging with SigLIP.
`--asset --volume --threshold`
`--labels FILE --apply --download`

**maki embed** *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Generate image embeddings.
`--asset --volume --force --export`

## Organize

**maki collection create** *NAME*
Create a static album. `--description`

**maki collection add** *NAME ASSET_IDS...*
Add assets to a collection.

**maki collection remove** *NAME ASSET_IDS...*
Remove assets from a collection.

**maki collection list / show / delete**
List, show contents, or delete collections.

**maki saved-search save** *NAME QUERY*
Save a search query. `--sort --favorite`

**maki saved-search list / run / delete**
List, run, or delete saved searches.

**maki stack create** *ASSET_IDS...*
Create a stack. First = pick.

**maki stack add** *REF ASSET_IDS...*
Add assets to existing stack.

**maki stack remove / pick / dissolve / list / show**
Stack management commands.

**maki stack from-tag** *PATTERN*
Convert tag patterns to stacks. `--apply --remove-tags`

**maki faces detect / cluster / people / name** [Pro]
Face detection and recognition.
`--query --asset --apply --min-confidence`

## Retrieve

**maki search** *QUERY*
Search assets with filters (see back).
`--format ids|short|full|json|{template}`
`-q` (shorthand for **--format ids**)

**maki show** *ASSET_ID*
Show full asset details.

**maki preview** *ASSET_ID*
Display preview in terminal. `--open`

**maki export** *QUERY TARGET*
Export to directory. `--zip --layout flat|mirror`
`--all-variants --sidecars`

**maki contact-sheet** *QUERY OUTPUT*
Generate PDF contact sheet.
`--layout --paper --landscape`
`--title --fields --sort`

**maki stats**
Catalog statistics. `--tags --verified`

**maki serve**
Start web UI. `--port --bind`

**maki shell**
Interactive shell. `-c CMD --script FILE`

## Maintain

**maki verify** *[PATHS...]*
Check file integrity.
`--volume --asset --force --max-age DAYS`

**maki sync** *[PATHS...]*
Sync with disk changes. `--apply --remove-stale`

**maki sync-metadata** *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Bidirectional XMP sync. `--asset --dry-run`

**maki refresh** *[PATHS...]*
Re-read changed recipes. `--dry-run`

**maki writeback** *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Write pending edits to XMP. `--all --dry-run`

**maki cleanup**
Remove stale records. `--apply --list --path`

**maki generate-previews** *[PATHS...]*
Generate/regenerate previews.
`--force --smart --upgrade`
`--volume --asset --include --skip`

**maki create-sidecars** *[QUERY]*
Create XMP sidecars for assets without recipes.
`--volume --asset --apply`

**maki relocate** *[ASSET_IDS...]*
Copy/move files between volumes.
`--target VOLUME --query --remove-source`
`--create-sidecars --dry-run`

**maki rebuild-catalog**
Rebuild SQLite from YAML sidecars.

**maki migrate**
Run database schema migrations.

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## Core Concepts

| | |
|---|---|
| **Asset** | Logical media item (one photo) |
| **Variant** | Concrete file (Original, Alternate, Processed, Export) |
| **Recipe** | XMP/processing sidecar (tracked by location) |
| **Volume** | Storage device (online/offline detection) |
| **Stack** | Collapsed group in browse (own metadata) |
| **Collection** | Static album (manual curation) |
| **Saved Search** | Dynamic smart album (query re-evaluated) |

## Key Workflows

### Import & Organize

1. `maki init` + `maki volume add`
2. `maki import --smart /path`
3. `maki serve` — browse in web UI
4. Rate, tag, label via UI or CLI
5. `maki auto-tag ""` [Pro]— AI tagging

### Maintenance Cycle

1. `maki verify` — check integrity
2. `maki sync` — detect moved/missing
3. `maki sync-metadata` — bidirectional XMP [Pro]
4. `maki cleanup --apply` — remove stale

### Backup & Archive

1. `maki volume add Archive /mnt/nas --purpose backup`
2. `maki relocate --target Archive ""` — copy all
3. `maki backup-status` — check coverage
4. `maki dedup --apply` — remove same-volume dups

### Export & Deliver

1. `maki export "rating:4+ tag:portfolio" ./out`
2. `maki export "collection:Client" ./out --zip`
3. `maki contact-sheet "rating:5" portfolio.pdf`

## Search Filter Syntax

All filters work in CLI `maki search` and web UI search box.

### Text & Metadata

| | |
|---|---|
| `tag:landscape` | Tag match (hierarchical) |
| `-tag:rejected` | Exclude tag |
| `type:image` | Asset type |
| `format:nef` | File format |
| `label:Red` | Color label |
| `camera:fuji` | Camera (partial) |
| `lens:56mm` | Lens (partial) |
| `person:Alice` | Named person [Pro] |
| `collection:Fav` | Collection |
| `path:2026/` | Path prefix |
| `id:72a0` | Asset ID prefix |
| `meta:key=val` | Source metadata |

### Numeric Filters

All support: `x` (exact), `x+` (min), `x-y` (range), `x,y` (OR)

| | |
|---|---|
| `rating:3+` | 3 stars or more |
| `rating:3-5` | 3 to 5 stars |
| `rating:2,4` | Exactly 2 or 4 |
| `iso:100-800` | ISO range |
| `focal:35-70` | Focal length range |
| `f:1.4-2.8` | Aperture range |
| `width:4000+` | Min width (px) |
| `height:2000+` | Min height (px) |
| `copies:2+` | File copies |
| `variants:2+` | Variant count |
| `scattered:2+` | Distinct directories (`/N` depth) |
| `duration:30+` | Video duration (seconds) |
| `codec:h264` | Video codec (partial) |
| `faces:2+` | Face count [Pro] |

### Date Filters

| | |
|---|---|
| `date:2026` | Year prefix |
| `date:2026-03` | Month prefix |
| `date:2026-03-15` | Exact date |
| `dateFrom:2026-01` | From (inclusive) |
| `dateUntil:2026-12` | Until (inclusive) |

### Status Filters

| | |
|---|---|
| `orphan:true` | No file locations |
| `orphan:false` | Has file locations |
| `missing:true` | Files missing on disk |
| `stale:30` | Not verified in N days |
| `stacked:true` | In a stack |
| `volume:Archive` | On specific volume |
| `volume:none` | No online volume |
| `geo:any` | Has GPS data |

### Pro Filters

| | |
|---|---|
| `similar:72a0bb4b` | Visual similarity |
| `min_sim:90` | Similarity threshold |
| `text:sunset` | Text-to-image search |
| `embed:none` | No embedding |

### Combining Filters

| | |
|---|---|
| `tag:a,b` | a OR b (comma) |
| `tag:a tag:b` | a AND b (repeat) |
| `-tag:x` | NOT (dash prefix) |

## Output Formats

`maki search --format` *`PRESET|TEMPLATE`*

| | |
|---|---|
| `ids` | One UUID per line |
| `short` | ID, name, type, format, date |
| `full` | + tags, description, rating |
| `json` | JSON array |
| `'{id}\t{name}'` | Custom template |

Placeholders: `{id}`, `{name}`, `{filename}`, `{type}`, `{format}`, `{tags}`, `{description}`, `{rating}`, `{label}`, `{date}`, `{size}`

## Configuration (maki.toml)

| | |
|---|---|
| `[preview]` | max_edge, format, quality, smart_max_edge |
| `[serve]` | port, bind, per_page |
| `[import]` | exclude, auto_tags, smart_previews, profiles |
| `[browse]` | default_filter |
| `[writeback]` | enabled (default: false) [Pro] |
| `[dedup]` | prefer |
| `[verify]` | max_age_days |
| `[ai]` | model, threshold, labels [Pro] |
| `[vlm]` | endpoint, model, timeout [Pro] |
| `[contact_sheet]` | layout, paper, fields |

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https://maki-dam.com/